

HAMMER'N HENRY

By HENRY BURKE

Daily Breeze Sports Editor

Jim Rice 'Little Sparkplug'

As New Orleans Hits Streak

The New Orleans Baseball Club of the Southern Association returned home from a road trip a week ago and the team was bubbling over with its traveling record of 18-6 over first division opponents. But getting even more attention were two local neighborhood youngsters, Jim Rice of Redondo and Les Phillips of Lomita.

Phillips is a relief pitcher for New Orleans who has a startling 11-2 record. Hollywood Star fans can expect Phillips to be the bullpen chief next year at the rate he's going.

There is also a lot of hope that Rice will make the grade in the PCL next season. He just missed making the Hollywood squad last spring.

Manager Andy Cohen of New Orleans requested to have Rice back in New Orleans again this year, and since Hollywood had Bill Mazaroski, Jim Baumer and all kinds of third baseman and shortstops, Rice was shipped out to play second base with the Pelicans.

Hitting around the .300 mark with the Pels, Rice increased the average a great deal the other day with eight consecutive hits. The eighth hit was a rousing

triple which beat first place Atlanta, 5-4, and gave New Orleans two straight victories over the leaders.

Bill Keefe wrote in a New Orleans newspaper that there's no question about the team being the hottest thing in the league at the moment, adding in the next paragraph . . . "And you can say that Jim Rice is the hottest player in the league right now."

That statement was also the sentiment of Manager Cohen who exclaimed, "How that kid can go! I'll bet he has more power per pound than any man in the league, and an eye like an eagle."

Paul Pettit of Hollywood was pleased to hear that his two pals, Rice and Phillips, were doing so well in New Orleans. They get pretty well in touch with each other through the mail.

Pettit hasn't been as fortunate about keeping in the line-up regularly, but has been getting a good share of hits when he's in the ball game.

Paul hit home runs last Saturday and Sunday to up his total to six for the year. Right at the start of the year he hit two homers in one game.

Pettit said that the reason why

the home runs seem to come in cycles depends upon how you feel. It also has a lot to do with luck.

Said Paul, "Sometimes you get a perfect pitch and hit it a mile and get another pitch just like it the next time at bat and you can just as easily pop it up on the infield."

It isn't hitting that bothers Pettit however. He said that keeping his throwing arm warm gives him most trouble, particularly going from a real warm afternoon to cold night game.

Pettit is used in the outfield, yet he is often called upon to pitch batting practice, and that's almost like being a regular pitcher in itself.

Then he questioned the idea of pitching batting practice and standing in a cool outfield an hour later. A ball is hit to him in right field and he fires the ball to third to nail a runner. Most players wouldn't stand for

26 DAILY BREEZE, Redondo Beach
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Seeded Players Bunch into Finals

BROOKLINE, Mass. (AP) — Competition stiffened with only one seeded entry on the sidelines in the 75th National Doubles tennis championships today.

Heading the advance through the first two rounds were six members of the Australian Davis Cup team, two promising youngsters waiting for a chance to gain a berth on the Aussie squad, and the two top tandems on the U. S. cup team.

Jerry Moss and Bill Quillian, beaten 1955 finalists seeded No. 5 this year, were overpowered by Mexican Davis Cup stars Francisco Contreras and Mario Llamas, 6-4, 6-4, 6-4.